PART I - SHORT NOTES

Q1. (a)

Akaki Akakievich is a low-ranking government clerk in St. Petersburg. His office is where he spends most of his life. Gogol uses it to show the dull, mechanical life of ordinary clerks.

The office is simple. Akaki's only duty is copying official documents, which he does with care and accuracy. He never complains. His colleagues do not respect him. They laugh at his old clothes, his quiet nature, and his simple life, and they treat him as unimportant. He does not argue. He stays patient and goes on with his work.

For Akaki the office is his whole world. He enjoys copying so much that he copies papers at home. He does not dream of promotion or power. After he gets the new overcoat, the office changes for a short time. His colleagues admire the coat, congratulate him, and arrange a party. That is the only time they give him respect. The office also stands for the rigid Russian bureaucracy, where rank matters more than character.

Q1. (b)

Petrovitch is the tailor who stitches Akaki's new overcoat. He is a minor character, but he changes the course of Akaki's life.

He is experienced, skilled, and proud of his work. He can be stubborn, because he insists on doing the work properly. When Akaki brings the old overcoat for repair, Petrovitch examines it and says it is beyond repair. He advises Akaki to buy a new one. Akaki is disappointed, because he cannot afford a new coat, but Petrovitch does not change his opinion. He believes a new coat is the only honest solution.

Petrovitch then helps Akaki choose good cloth and stitches the overcoat with care. The finished coat is beautiful and becomes Akaki's greatest happiness. Petrovitch charges for his work, but he is not dishonest. He wants the coat to be strong and durable. He stands for the hardworking craftsman who lives by skill. Without his decision, the main events of the story would not take place.

Q1. (c)

After Mudli's mysterious and violent death, Eeri's life is filled with hardship and loneliness. As a widow she has to raise Seena by herself. She loves her son deeply, because he is the only memory of her dead husband.

She works hard to fulfil Seena's wishes. She even buys him a mobile phone, hoping it will make him happy. She hopes for government compensation after Mudli's death, but it never comes, and that adds to her worry. Her life becomes centred on caring for Seena, who grows irresponsible and unstable. She later arranges his marriage to Shalini, hoping marriage will steady him, but Seena continues his unhealthy habits.

Eeri suffers in silence while village tales accuse her of immoral relationships and damage her dignity. Her life shows the struggle of a rural widow: poverty, gossip, and an emotional burden, with nobody to support her.

Q1. (d)

Kirubunkal shows the Indian tradition of storytelling, in which tales, or kathe, are part of the living culture of a community. In the village, tales are not only entertainment. They shape belief, identity, and collective memory.

Elders such as Hirikateyajji carry the tales from one generation to the next. They give life to nature, people, and culture. Tales travel from village to village, change their form, and mix truth with imagination. They explain strange events, moral questions, and social relations.

In Kirubunkal that sacred tradition grows weak. False rumours and sensational stories take the place of meaningful tales. Instead of wisdom, the new tales spread fear, lust, division, and lies. Through the talking tales, the story shows that India's storytelling heritage once guided society, and that it is now threatened by misinformation and the loss of values.

PART I - LONG ANSWERS

Q2. (a)

Nikolai Gogol describes the struggles of ordinary people. The Overcoat is the story of Akaki Akakievich, a poor clerk who lives a lonely and simple life. His greatest wish is a warm overcoat. Through that wish Gogol shows what poverty does to a common man.

Akaki's poverty is clear from the beginning. His salary is very small, and he spends almost all of it on basic needs. He cannot afford good food, a comfortable room, or warm clothing. His room is small and poorly furnished. There is no luxury and no comfort in his life.

His old overcoat is so worn that it cannot protect him from the freezing winter of St. Petersburg. The tailor tells him that the coat cannot be repaired. Buying a new one is a heavy burden. A rich man could buy a coat easily. For Akaki it takes months of sacrifice. He eats less, gives up tea, walks carefully so that his shoes will last, and spends nothing on anything he does not need. Every small coin is saved for the coat.

He never complains. He remains honest and hardworking. The coat is not just clothing. It is protection from the cold, and it is his greatest dream. Even after he buys it, the happiness is short. Thieves steal the coat. He loses his savings, his hope, and his happiness. The authorities do not help him recover it. Poor people are ignored by society and by government officials.

Gogol uses this life to criticise a society in which hardworking people suffer while the rich enjoy comfort and respect. Akaki's sacrifices, his simple life, and the loss of the coat make the pain of poverty real.

Q2. (b)

The Overcoat is not only the story of one clerk. It is a picture of class difference in nineteenth-century Russia.

Akaki belongs to the lower class. He earns a small salary and struggles to meet even his basic needs. Senior government officials, by contrast, enjoy wealth, comfort, and respect. Society values them for their rank, not for their character.

Akaki's colleagues mock him because he is poor and timid. They ignore his opinions and do not treat him with dignity. After he buys the new overcoat, the same people suddenly respect him. Society judges a person by appearance and possessions.

The important official stands for the upper class. He misuses his authority and humiliates Akaki instead of helping him. That incident shows the injustice faced by the poor. The theft of the overcoat shows the insecurity of the lower class. Akaki loses everything because he has no power and no influence.

Even after Akaki's death, the ghost takes the important official's overcoat. That reversal of power suggests that justice can challenge class inequality. Gogol criticises a society divided by wealth, status, and power, and he asks that every person be given dignity, kindness, and equal treatment.

Q2. (c)

Ravikumar Neha blends traditional folklore with modern literature. In Kirubunkal the two traditions are the traditional folk culture and the modern way of thinking. He keeps both of them in the story.

The folk tradition appears in oral storytelling, myths, village customs, beliefs, and legends. Hirikateyajji preserves the old stories and passes them to the younger generation. People respect elders, nature, and cultural traditions. Festivals, rituals, and local beliefs are part of their lives. The language is close to everyday speech, like the speech of an elder telling a story in a village.

The modern tradition appears in people who question old beliefs. Seena wants to look modern and fashionable. He is influenced by city life, modern education, and new ideas. Modern thinking brings curiosity, scientific ideas, and a change in the way people live.

Neha does not treat one tradition as wholly right and the other as wholly wrong. Folk stories still matter in modern society because they keep cultural identity. Modern thinking helps people understand life without throwing away the past. He uses modern literary technique to tell traditional stories, so the novella can reach a modern reader. Storytelling itself is the bridge between the past and the present.

The combination teaches that a society grows when it respects both tradition and progress. Old stories show people their roots. Modern ideas help them face the future.

PART II - WRITING SKILLS

Q3. (1)

LAKSHMI COSMETICS
Bazaar Street, Davangere - 577002
12 August 2025
The Sales Manager
Karnataka Cosmetics
Industrial Area, Hubli
Dear Sir,
Sub: Enquiry for cosmetic items.

I am the owner of a cosmetics shop in Davangere. I wish to purchase a stock of different cosmetic items for my shop. Please send your latest catalogue and quote for the following.

1. Face cream, shampoo, toilet soap, talcum powder, and lipstick, with the varieties and pack sizes you supply.
2. The price of each item, and any trade discount.
3. The quality and the warranty or guarantee, if any.
4. The mode of payment, the time needed for supply, and the transport charges.

I will place an order only after I receive your catalogue and quotation. Please reply within a week.
Thank you.
Yours faithfully,
Proprietor

Q3. (2)

CHETAN BOOKS
P.B. Road, Near Bus Stand, Davangere - 577002
20 August 2025
The Proprietor
Vinayaka Book House
Nehru Road, Shimoga
Dear Sir,
Sub: Quotation for books.
Ref: Your letter asking for a quotation, dated 12 August 2025.
Thank you for your letter. We are pleased to quote for the books in our stock.

Book	Binding	Price per copy (Rs.)
An Anthology of English Prose	Paperback	180
An Anthology of Modern Poetry	Paperback	160
An Anthology of One-Act Plays	Paperback	170
Communicative English Textbook	Paperback	200

1. Discount: 15 percent on an order of more than 50 copies of any title.
2. Delivery: within 7 working days of a confirmed order. Transport is free if the order is above Rs. 10,000.
3. Payment: by online transfer within 15 days of the invoice.
4. This quotation is valid for 30 days.

Please send your order if the terms suit you. A catalogue is enclosed.
Thank you.
Yours faithfully,
Proprietor

Q3. (3)

VINAYAKA BOOK HOUSE
Nehru Road, Shimoga

28 August 2025
The Manager
Chetan Books
P.B. Road, Near Bus Stand
Davangere - 577002
Dear Sir,
Sub: Order for books.
Ref: Your quotation dated 20 August 2025.
Thank you for your quotation. Please supply the following books.

Book	Copies	Binding
An Anthology of English Prose	60	Paperback
An Anthology of Modern Poetry	60	Paperback
An Anthology of One-Act Plays	50	Paperback
Communicative English Textbook	80	Paperback

1. Discount: we accept your 15 percent discount, since each title is above 50 copies.
2. Payment: online transfer within 15 days of receiving the invoice.
3. Delivery: please dispatch the books within 7 working days, with free transport, as the order is above Rs. 10,000.
Please pack the books securely and confirm the dispatch.
Thank you.
Yours faithfully,
Proprietor

Q3. (4)

SRI VINAYAKA MEDICALS
Nehru Road, Shimoga
5 September 2025
Nutan Medical Wholesale Dealers
Hubli
Dear Sir,
Sub: Complaint about improper execution of our order.
Ref: Our order No. SVM/48/2025.
We refer to the order placed with you. The goods received do not match that order. Some of the medicines supplied are not the items we asked for, and the quantity of the correct items is short. This has inconvenienced our customers, and we cannot sell goods that were not ordered.
Please arrange, at your cost, to take back the wrong items and to supply the medicines exactly as ordered, in the full quantity. Kindly confirm when this will be done.
We have dealt with you regularly and hope you will set this right at once.
Thank you.
Yours faithfully,
Proprietor

Q3. (5)

DEEPA COSMETICS
Industrial Estate, Davangere - 577002
1 October 2025
Dear Customer,
Sub: Invitation to our stall.
We manufacture a range of cosmetic items, including creams, soaps, shampoos, and powders. We are glad to inform you that we have taken a stall in the examination to be held in the first week of next month.
Please visit our stall during that week. You can see the full range, and our staff will explain the quality and the prices. We will be happy to note your requirements there.
We look forward to meeting you.
Yours faithfully,
Proprietor

Q3. (6)

1. **Agenda:** A list of the items of business to be considered at a meeting.
2. **Bull:** A speculator on the stock exchange who buys shares when prices are expected to rise, so that he can sell them later at a higher price and make a profit.
3. **Catalogue:** A booklet or brochure published by the seller. It describes the goods, usually with pictures, and gives the prices, make, qualities, and terms of trade.
4. **Demat account:** A dematerialised account. It is an electronic account that holds securities such as shares, bonds, mutual funds, government securities, and exchange traded funds in digital form. A bank account holds money. A demat account holds securities.
5. **Invoice:** The bill sent by a seller to a buyer for goods sent or services given.